consideration. The issues like climatic change, natural and anthropogenic disasters are also the major concerns.

i. ***Population Geography*** is the study of distribution and density of population, the changing patterns in age and sex composition, birth and death rates, life expectancy, literacy level and dependency ratio, migrations at national and international level and the causes and consequences of migration.

ii. ***Settlement Geography*** deals with the characteristics of rural and urban settlements and transportation network. It seeks better understanding of the present landscape and plans for the future. The study is more important for town and country planning.

iii. ***Historical Geography*** tries to picturise the geography of an area or region as it was in the past and studies how it has evolved over time. The forces involved in transforming region such as colonisation by the Europeans or a natural disaster are also included in the study.

iv. ***Anthropo Geography*** deals with the distribution of human communities on the earth in relation to their geographical environment.

v. ***Cultural Geography*** gives emphasis on the location and diffusion of customs and cultural traits such as food habits, skills, clothing and beliefs and social organisations and their developments in different parts of the earth.

vi. ***Social Geography*** is closely related to cultural geography. It examines the relationships among the social groups and their social relationships in the places of their living.

vii. ***Political Geography*** tries to understand the countries and their neighbours, problems of resources sharing, boundaries and territorial limits. This branch is also concerned with understanding the political behaviour of the population, relations between independent states, and patterns of voting and delimitation of electoral constituencies.

viii. ***Economic Geography*** deals with the distribution of economic activities such as, primary, secondary and tertiary. The primary activities include food gathering, hunting, animal rearing, agriculture, and mining. The secondary activities include manufacturing and the tertiary activities include the service sectors such as trade, transport, communication tourism and other related areas.

xi. ***Medical Geography*** mainly deals with study of geographical aspects of origin, diffusion and distribution of various communicable diseases and health care planning.

1.7.3 Geographic Techniques

Geography has developed a number of methods and tools to investigate and identify the spatial structures and patterns. Besides, it also lends or borrows some methods and tools to measure and investigate precise understanding of the spatial locations and patterns.

i. ***Mathematical Geography*** deals with the study of earth's size and shape, motions of the earth, concept of time and the time zones.

ii. ***Statistical Geography*** is concerned with the practice of collecting, analysing and presenting data that has a geographic or areal dimension, such as census data.

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